

# The Diet Guide

Everything you need to get lean — and stay there.

---

*This is how I actually eat to stay shredded, stripped down to what matters. No fads, no starving. I highly recommend reading this all the way through once, just to let the information settle — it should take 5 minutes max.*

Before anything else, understand this: a diet is a lifestyle choice. It's changing your default meals — and a few habits around them:

- how you shop for food,
- how you order at a restaurant,
- how you approach food in general.

Food is meant to be enjoyed — intentionally.

**If you want a crazy body, you have to have a somewhat crazy diet. People have called my diet crazy. To me, it's just a lifestyle choice.**

## The Game: Two Levers

---

Getting lean comes down to two things:

- **Calories in, calories out** — how much you eat vs. how much you burn.
- **Body fat** — the percentage you carry on your frame.

Calories in vs. calories out determine your weight. Body fat determines how you look. Diet is the main lever you control for both — and combined with training in the gym, it's what gets you the lean aesthetic. For reference, a lean build sits around 10–12% body fat.

## The 4 Principles

---

### 1. Make it sustainable.

Food is meant to be enjoyed. Any diet that treats eating as the enemy will fail. Keep the foods you love — just account for them. This is a lifestyle, not a punishment.

### 2. Protein is the foundation.

Protein anchors every meal. It's what makes you full — not carbs, not anything else. Treat it like an all-you-can-eat buffet and control everything else around it. The reason: protein is badly underrepresented in the Asian diet. Even if you feel like you're eating a lot, unless you're actually tracking it, you're almost certainly eating less than you think. Aim for at least 0.8g per

pound of bodyweight (a 150 lb person → ~120g/day). The more you eat, the more muscle you build.

### 3. Carbs are strategic — be intentional.

A carb is fast energy and calorie-dense, so spend it on purpose. There's a big difference between eating white rice just because it's in front of you and enjoying real Italian pasta you actually want. Say yes to the pasta, no to the autopilot rice. Use a small amount pre-workout for fuel, otherwise treat carbs as a condiment that helps the protein go down. Sugar counts as carbs too.

### 4. Everything else fits.

Once you've hit your protein and you're at or below maintenance calories, the rest of the budget is yours. A budget isn't restriction — it's being smart about where you spend.

## How to Execute

---

There are two levels. Start wherever fits your life — both work.

### Level 1 — Just eat less.

A pure mindset shift, no apps. Generally aim for fewer carbs and stop at about 8 out of 10 fullness every meal — satisfied, never stuffed. A simple trick: eat lighter in the morning so you've got room to enjoy more in the evening.

### Level 2 — Track for one month.

Log everything for a month just to see how food adds up — it builds an intuition you keep for life. Use this [BMR calculator](#) to find your maintenance, then aim for ~200 below. That buffer keeps you in a deficit even on days you slip. Once the intuition is built, you can ease off the logging.

Either way, two habits help:

- **Build a default meal.** Pick 2–3 high-protein, low-carb meals you can fall back on any day. They free up your budget for the meals that matter.
- **Work with your biology.** Don't eat just because it's “mealtime” or because everyone else is. Eat when you're actually hungry.

## The Biggest Mistakes

---

- **Guessing your calories.** Most people are way off. A single spoon of peanut butter can hide a couple hundred calories. Until you've measured with a scale, you don't actually know.
- **Underestimating hidden carbs.** Bread, noodles, sauces, drinks — they add up fast and quietly. This is the #1 reason a “clean” diet stalls.
- **Forcing meal timing.** You don't need six meals on a clock. Rigid timing makes the diet harder to live with, not more effective.

- **Cutting carbs out completely.** Carbs aren't the enemy — mindless carbs are. If it's amazing dumplings or real Italian pasta, the carb is worth it. If it's white rice or noodles just sitting there, you don't have to finish them. Eat fewer carbs through the day and you can reward yourself at night with something sweet. That's what keeps the diet sustainable.

## A Note on Asian Food

---

Carbs are built deep into our food — rice, noodles, dumpling wrappers. They sneak up on you more than in most cuisines. You don't have to cut them out; just be deliberate. Lead with the protein on your plate and let the rice play a supporting role.

The flip side is that protein gets barely any priority in Asian cuisine. So look for small ways to add more — throw in extra eggs, or order an additional protein side dish. Little habits like these are what optimize the Asian diet.

## Quick FAQ

---

### Won't fewer carbs leave me low on energy?

Short term you may notice it as your body adjusts. But with enough protein and strategic carbs around your workouts, energy holds up fine — and most people feel steadier without the crashes that come from carb-heavy meals.

### What if I get hungry at night?

Plan for it. Skip breakfast and save those calories for a midnight snack — ideally something that helps you wind down, eaten about 2 hours before you sleep. Shifting when you eat, not just what, makes the diet far easier to stick to.

## Best Protein Sources

---

- **Lean meat:** Chicken breast, lean beef, pork, turkey
- **Seafood:** Most white fish, salmon, tuna, shrimp
- **Eggs:** Whole eggs and egg whites
- **Dairy:** Greek yogurt, cottage cheese, milk
- **Plant-based:** Tofu, tempeh, edamame, lentils
- **Supplements:** Whey or plant protein to fill the gap on busy days

## What Good Meals Look Like

---

Real meals, not photoshoots. Notice the pattern: protein leads, carbs stay portioned, veggies show up.



*Beef patty + cheese leads. Rice is the side, not the star — plus steamed veggies.*



*Steak + eggs + tomato. Rice kept in its own bowl — carbs as a condiment.*



*Chicken thighs, blended greens, soup. Protein-forward, no rice needed.*

## Eating Out & Ordering In

You don't have to cook every meal. Lead with the protein, keep the carbs in check, and you can hit your goals anywhere.



*Restaurant plate: grilled chicken leads, eggs stack the protein, rice stays one portion.*



*Order-in done right: load up on the meat add-ons, go easy on the noodles.*



*Buffet: shrimp, fish, and roast beef pile up first — pasta is just a taste.*

**Master the basics and the rest takes care of itself. Keep it sustainable — that's the whole game.**